Boston Sunday Globe

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An unlikely scene of trouble roils island idyll

Vineyard questions how an alleged rape could occur at police barracks

By Chris Serres and Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

OAK BLUFFS — With its stately Victorian façade, well-kept lawn, and white picket fence, the Massachusetts State Police barracks in Oak Bluffs looks like the postcard image of Martha's Vineyard.

Now it's a crime scene.

On the morning of Aug. 15, a woman was found naked on the roadside near the remote barracks, screaming for help. Prosecutors allege a Boston Public Schools emergency management employee raped the woman after meeting her at an Oak Bluffs bar and bringing her back to the barracks, where he was staying as a guest of a state trooper.

The incident raises chilling questions: If someone isn't safe inside a State Police barracks, then where else? And if an attack happens inside a state law enforcement facility, where does the victim flee for help?

As more details emerge, residents and visitors in this coastal community of 5,300 are struggling to reconcile the savagery of the alleged assault with the quaint backdrop of Martha's Vineyard — a serene island better known for its pristine beaches, multimillion-dollar

BARRACKS, Page A15

Tariffs weigh on campaign in key state

Trump's Canada levies hit Michigan especially

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

PORT HURON, Mich. — These have not been record-setting times at the Elite Feet running store.

The high cost of living is forcing people to wait longer to replace their running shoes, said owner Greg Whitican. The tariffs President Trump slapped on Vietnam, where most of the shoes are made, have increased prices $10 to $15 a pair.

And the trade war Trump launched last year with Canada, just across the Blue Water Bridge less than a 10K run from the store, has slowed the flow of Canadian customers to a trickle while cutting the store's monthly sales by 15 percent to 20 percent.

"We used to get a lot of Canadian customers. They're right there," Whitican, 62, said one recent afternoon, motioning through the store's front window toward Sarnia, Ontario, on the other side of the nearby St. Clair River. "They've been like our brothers my whole life. They didn't do anything."

The affordability crisis, inflamed by Trump's second-term tariffs and the steep increase in fu-

TARIFFS, Page A12

WHY MASS. LOST ITS MOJO — AND HOW WE GET IT BACK

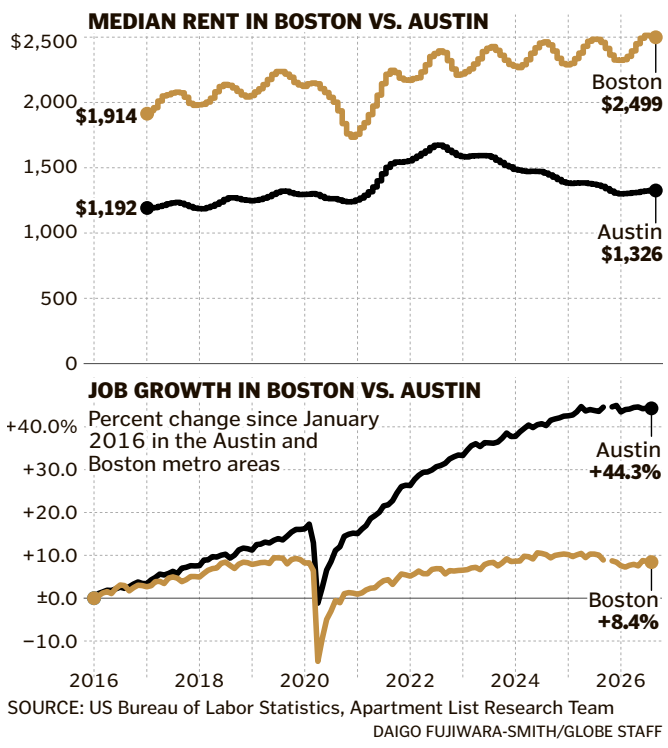
ONE-WAY FLIGHT TO AUSTIN

Texas city is top target for young professionals fleeing high-cost Boston



JOEL ANGEL JUAREZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Armando Bisono walked by Lady Bird Lake near downtown Austin. After less than a day in the city he said, "I want to stay forever."



SOURCE: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Apartment List Research Team

DAIGO FUJIWARA-SMITH/GLOBE STAFF

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

AUSTIN, Texas — It didn't take long for this town to make an impression on Armando Bisono.

After the grueling drive from Boston, the 24-year-old packed his first full day here with Austin's greatest hits: a large helping of brisket at Terry Black's Barbecue; a dip in Barton Springs, the city's popular natural swimming hole; and a late-night perusal of the nightlife district, where the music was loud, the bars were packed, and the University of Texas Longhorns were dominating on every television screen.

"I want to stay forever," Bisono proclaimed on hour 16 in his new city.

When Bisono and his roommate, Marino Ginebra, moved from Boston to Austin in September, they joined a growing club of emigres. Texas has become a top destination for those leaving Massachusetts, and young people in particular are exiting at an alarming rate, IRS data show. Bisono and Ginebra both came to Boston for college, worked in the city for a year, then decided to head south in search of cheaper housing, better weather, and a stronger entrepreneurial landscape for their fledgling supplement business. In Austin, they hope to find more job opportunities and a lifestyle more suitable for 20-somethings who are past the college partying stage but not yet settled down.

In Boston, Bisono said, all of his friends talked about moving; many of them already had.

"I was making just enough to live," said Bisono, who works at a large logistics company. In Austin, he said, "I'm paying less rent, and I'm getting more."

In Austin, jobs are up, rent is down, and there are cranes in the

AUSTIN, Page A14

A civic leader's message on living with Alzheimer's

By Lee Pelton

I have Alzheimer's.

It's a disease that feels as hard to accept as it is to defeat.

I have always loved writing, reading, and speaking. It's defined who I am from a very early age. I have built my life around words and ideas, and I have always tried to use them to improve the places that I've been fortunate enough to help lead — college campuses, nonprofits, the communities to which I belong.

Now I'm writing this because I've found myself a member of a new community: Alzheimer's



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Lee Pelton retired as president and CEO of The Boston Foundation this summer.

patients. I'm hoping, through these words, to offer a window into what is a fear and abstraction for many. In describing my own experience, I'm also hoping you may be better able to understand and help those around you with Alzheimer's.

When I look back on my journey, I'm lucky to be able to say that I've loved my life — the leadership roles, the speeches, the essays, the opportunity to truly make a difference. And now I'm coming to terms — and not easily — with the fact that this unforgiving disease might take it all away from me. In doing so, I live in fear that it might take my very identity with it.

PELTON, Page A16



A night at the Lizzie Borden house in Fall River leads the writer to realize you can't separate the house from what haunts it. **SundayTravel, N15.**

A designer well versed in accommodations for physical limitations melds beauty and safety to make this Gloucester house a forever home. **Address, H1.**

A family's finances can be undone by a single catastrophic event, and some of these families turn to Globe Santa for help making the holidays joyful for their children. **Metro, B1.**

A rake in the action

Sunday: Sunny. High: 52-57. Low: 42-47.
Monday: Sunny. High: 56-61. Low: 45-50.
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Complete report, **A24.**

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[1]Fixed market rate at time of conversion; one time conversion fee required.